JAMESCLEMENT ONYEKACHI UGWU

Quantitative Finance | Monetary Economics | Time-Series Econometrics | Asset-price Dynamics
F.C.T., Abuja-Nigeria | ugwuclement94@gmail.com| **Site:** https://ugwujamesclement.github.io/ ***(In Progress).***
LinkedIn: Onyekachi Jamesclement Ugwu | **ORCID:** https://orcid.org/0009-0000-2538-8994 | **ResearchGate:** Jamesclement Onyekachi Ugwu
Academia: https://independent.academia.edu/JamesClementUgwu | **Google Scholar:** https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=QJjcBtUAAAAJ

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE:

I am an early-career researcher in quantitative finance and monetary economics, using econometrics and quantitative modelling to turn market and macroeconomic data into sound investment and policy decisions. I am the founder of Refine 7, a pre-launch research and data start-up (launching 2027), and I lead the development of its macroeconomic and financial database. I led a five-member team to the national final of the CFA Institute Research Challenge (MTN Nigeria equity report). My work spans time-series econometrics, valuation, risk analysis and forecasting, with a growing interest in stochastic and dynamic modelling of interest rates and asset-price dynamics, which I am developing into a multi-year research agenda (2026 to 2031). I am also designing a proposed one-year randomised controlled trial, using survival analysis, on time to monetisation among creative professionals.

With minimal or no guidance, I can hit the ground running. I bring a researcher's rigor, teacher's clarity, and communicator's creativity to every project I take on. Within my workspace, I am open-minded to unlearn, relearn and learn new things. More importantly, as I advance through my career path, it has been my firm resolve to be resourceful to myself, my team, my superiors, my supervisor, and my institution

EDUCATION

SOUTH DAKOTA STATE UNIVERSITY (SDSU). **Brookings, USA.**
Programme: *Masters of Sciences (M.Sc.), Economics.* (admitted 2025; entry deferred).
Specialization: General Economics (major).
Minors: Health, and Econometrics.

Research Assistantship Award Recipient

- Admitted to the M.Sc. Economics programme
- Awarded a competitive Research Assistantship
- Programme Start deferred

UNIVERSITY OF NIGERIA, NSUKKA (UNN). **Enugu-State, Nigeria.**
Programme: *Bachelor of Sciences (B.Sc.), Economics.* (2016-2020-21).
Qualification/Honours: *Upper Second (Magna cum Laude)* June 2021.
Selected Coursework: Mathematical Economics, Statistics, Applied Statistics & Econometrics, Advanced Statistics & Econometrics, Computing Applications for Economists, Business Finance, Business mgmt. Accounting, Research Methods & Development Economics.

RESEARCH PROFILE

Methodological Interests and Expertise, Quantitative Skills & Computational Databases

- **Econometrics**
  a) Linear Regression (OLS, ARDL, Time-Series, Cross-Sectional, and Panel-Data) Analysis. b) Logistic Regression Analysis (Binary, Ordered, and Multinomial Logit) models. c) Probit and Tobit models. d) Duration Models (Count Model analysis, Negative Binomial estimation, and Survival Analysis.
- **Market Research, Business Strategy, and Financial Modelling**
  a) Mapping & Market Sizing – Total Addressable Market; TAM, Serviceable Addressable Market; SAM, and Serviceable Obtainable Market; SOM b) Competitive Benchmarking (DCF valuation and WACC modelling using Aswath Damodaran datasets. c) SOTA Risk Analysis (Monte Carlo simulations, Scenario (what-if) analysis, Sensitivity analysis and d) Strategic Planning Frameworks (SWOT analysis, PEST/PESTLE analysis, and Porter's Five Forces).

FUNDED RESEARCH, COLLABORATIVE GRANTS, AND COMPETITIVE RESEARCH

A. Enterprise Funded Projects

1. Macroeconomic and Financial Intelligence Database Development 2026 – Present.
Lead Researcher | Refine7 (Research, Finance & Investment Start-up). **Abuja, Nigeria.**

- Leading the development and compilation of a structured database containing selected macroeconomic, financial, and socio-economic time-series indicators to support investment research, economic analysis, and strategic decision-making.
- Designing data structures and analytical frameworks for monitoring economic trends, financial markets, and socio-economic indicators.

Methods/Tools: Economic Data Analysis| Time-Series Data Management| Financial Research |Data Curation.

2. Dangote Oil Refinery Strategic Appraisal November, 2022.
Research Analyst | Confidential Investment Client **Lagos - State, Nigeria.**

- Conducted a strategic appraisal of Dangote Refinery as a mega project during its final development stage for investment assessment purposes.
- Evaluated industrial significance, energy-sector implications, market positioning and sustainability impact.

Methods/Tools: Strategic Analysis| Industrial Economics | Investment Research.

3. Details of my awarded grants and funded research in other domains (Health and Agriculture) are available in my comprehensive CV at the website linked in the header above.

4. MTN Nigeria Equity Research Challenge (CFA Institute) Oct, 2020 – April 2021.
Team Lead | Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) Institute Research Challenge | **Nationwide, Nigeria.**

- Led a five-member team in developing a 30-page equity research report analysing MTN Nigeria, one of Nigeria and West Africa's largest telecommunication companies.
- Conducted financial statement analysis, industry research, competitive positioning, and intrinsic and relative valuation.
- Selected among eight finalist teams nationwide to present investment recommendations at the national grand finale.

Tools: Equity Valuation| Financial Analysis | Investment Research.

3. *Unilever PLC. Sustainability and Circular Economy Analysis.* April, 2021. **London, United Kingdom.**

- Analysed Unilever PLC's 2019 Annual Report using Five Capitals and Circular Economy Frameworks.

Tools: Investment Research| Report Review | Business Strategy Tools/Analysis

5. **Global Creative Shock Challenge** **Vilnius, Lithuania.**
Team Lead Sept. 2018 – Dec. 2018.

- Led a team of four to undertake tasks on finance, marketing, public relations, and strategy problems of businesses.
- Selected out of 1000 participating teams as 1 of 100 that made it to the final round of the challenge.

RESEARCH OUTPUTS AND SCHORLARLY CONTRIBUTIONS

Peer-reviewed Publications.

1. **British Medical Journal (BMJ):** *Household Living Conditions and Food Insecurity in Nigeria: A Longitudinal Study During Covid-19 Pandemic* (2022) – https://doi.org/10.1136/bmjopen-2022-066810

B.Sc. Dissertation |Open Source (Available on Academia & ResearchGate)

2. Climate change and Agricultural Productivity Nexus: An ARDL (Autoregressive Distributed Lag Model) Approach. | Available on: https://doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.15361.33121 | *Also Available on Academia Database*

WORK AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Refine 7 (Research, Finance, Investment and Data Analysis) **Abuja, Nigeria.**
Founder, Executive Director. Launching April 2027.

- Founder of Refine 7, a start-up that is building proprietary global data platforms on markets, economies, and consumer opinion.
- Developing 3 flagship portals, Findex Voxdex, and Ecodex, to give people and businesses better research and advisory services.
- To offer secondary macroeconomic and financial data brokerage and analytical services for customers (individuals and businesses).

Freelance Remote Gigs (Fiverr, Mercor, and Mindrift) **Remote, Worldwide.**
Annotation and RLHF Specialist (AI-trainer) August 2024 – Present

- *RLHF and Model Tuning:* Specialized in Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback (RLHF) through reward model training.
- *Advanced Annotation*: Expertise in complex Data Labelling, Prompt Engineering, and creating comprehensive Evaluation Rubrics for model alignment.

National Accounts, Energy and Environmental Statistics Division (NAESSD),
National Bureau of Statistics (NBS), **Abuja, Nigeria.**
Graduate Special Assistant to Chief Economist & National Youth Service Corp (NYSC) Nov. 2021 – Feb. 2023.

- Successfully collated the statutory allocation and internally generated revenue of states in Nigeria.
- Successfully contributed to the retrieval of institutional periodic data from public parastatals in Abuja.
- Collaborated and partook in data outsourcing, surveys, and field trips to different states for data collection.

PARG, (Policy Analysis and Research Group) UNN **Enugu-State, Nigeria.**
Director of Research and Academic Planning (DRAP; elected) July 2019- August 2021

- Organized annual parliamentary policy debate, developed, and managed PARG's E-library and media repository.
- Mentored enthusiastic analysts, organized intra-university field trip,
- Successfully directed over 40 research projects and their subsequent official presentations.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Catholic Lectors Association of Nigeria *(CLAN),* Catholic Secretariat of Nigeria (CSN). **F.C.T, Abuja Nigeria.**
Chairman, Byelaw-Drafting Committee. May 2024 – August 2025.

- Led a 5-man committee inclusive of lawyers to draft a byelaw for the association.

*Chairman, **INEC (Independent NESA Electoral Commission).*** June 2021 – August 2021.

- Successfully superintended the conducting of credible election & transition of Govt. **Enugu-State, Nigeria**

*Secretary | President, **Students Board of Lectors (SBL), UNN**.* April 2018 | May 2019 – Aug. 2021.

- Successfully developed 10 years reading directory and edited a maiden reading guide.
- Increased the board's annual revenue by 63% through strategic introduction of utility pamphlets and programmes.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Happy End Academy, Odim Gate, UNN. **Enugu-State, Nigeria.**
Pre-College Tutor [Economics, English Language]. March 2017 – July, 2021.
• Consistently improved the performances of over 65% of students in their external tests.

*Team Lead, **Academic Tutorials, UNN.*** April 2017 – June 2021, **Enugu, Nigeria.**

- Personally reviewed, summarized and developed revision questions from 7 General Studies' (GS) courses for all students of UNN.
- Led a 4-man team that periodically organize and teach in Revision classes and tutorials for school mates [**Applied Computing to Economics, Econometrics, Advanced Statistics, & Intermediate Micro & Macro Economics]**
- Successfully organized and mobilized funds for fees and tuitions of indigent and bereaved course mates.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

- **Royal Society of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene (RSTMH)** **London, UK.**
- **Policy Analysis and Research Group** *(PARG Senior-ranking member)* **Nigeria**
- **Data Science Nigeria (DSN)** - **Nigeria**
- **Nigerian Statistical Association (NSA)** - **Nigeria**
- **Nigerian Economic Society (NES)** - **Nigeria**
- **Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) –** *(Digital member, not a charter holder)* **Nigeria.**

CONFERENCES, SEMINARS, AND EVENTS.

- **RSTMH Global Research in Progress Webinar, (Colloquium).** **Virtual, June 2025.**
- **Delegate, National Youth Confab.** October 7 – 8, 2026.

- **RSTMH Annual General Meeting & Grants Workshop.** **London, United Kingdom**.
  Equitable partnerships in Global Health October 15 – 17, 2026.

- **CFA Institute Webinar:** Harnessing AI for smarter Investment Decisions. Apr 24, 2025.

SKILLS, INTERESTS, AND AWARDS

Other soft skills: Leadership, Critical Thinking, Human management, Emotional Intelligence, Negotiation skills, Communication skills, Analytical and business skills, Logic & Philosophy, Script Writing, and Sales.

Interests: • Entrepreneurship • Travelling • Artificial Intelligence (AI) Creation • Social Media • Music and • News.

Merit Awards:

• Best Researcher [Policy Analysis and Research Group - 2021].
• Leadership Excellence [PARG, 2021].
• Leadership Excellence [SBL, 2021].
• Most Resourceful member [PARG – 2021]
• Excellence for Selfless Service [UNN, 2021]
• Best Policy Debater [PARG & NESA, 2018-2020] and More.

REFEREES

Available on Request.